

Which One Should You Buy?

Since processors are generally bought depending on one's needs, we have divided our conclusions accordingly. The above graph gives a clear indication of the processing power available at particular price point—Price/Performance.

The Budget PC

For a typical budget PC, processor priced below Rs 6000/- is an ideal buy. From the above graph the AMD Athlon64 3000+ (AM2) is the cheapest one can get for a budget PC. Since it is based on the newer AM2 platform, DDR2 will be the de-facto memory required, so you don't have to buy new memory when you upgrade. The processor is capable of delivering a decent performance in day-to-day applications, but don't expect too much on the multimedia and gaming fronts.

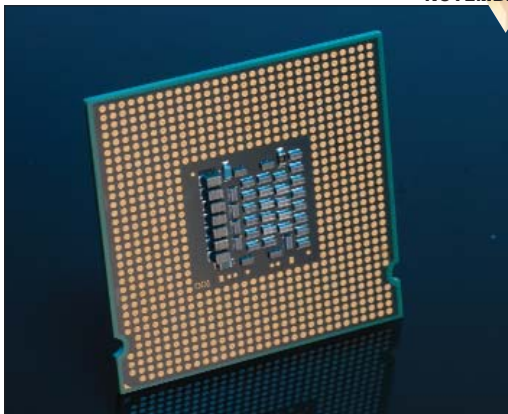
The Typical Home PC

A typical home PC can be made using a budget processor, but when running applications such as anti-virus applications and media encoding, having some reserve processing power helps a great deal when multi-tasking.

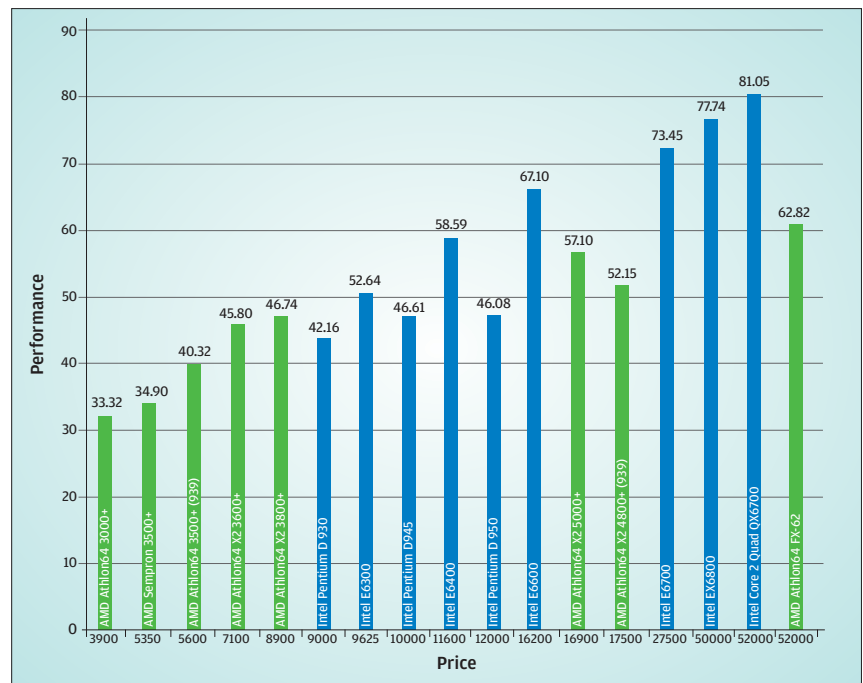
A processor priced in the Rs 7000 to Rs 10,000 range makes as an ideal buy for a good home PC. There are five processors in this range, consisting of two AMDs and three Intels. Both the AMD processors are based on Socket AM2, they make for a decent buy. On the Intel side, two processors are from the older Pentium D series—not worth it, really. The Intel E6300 priced at Rs 9,625 is a good buy, looking at the performance on offer, and also the low amount of heat it generates. In fact, at around Rs 1,000 more than the AMD Athlon64 X2 3800+, the E6300 offers a much better performance across the board.

The Mid-range Gaming Machine

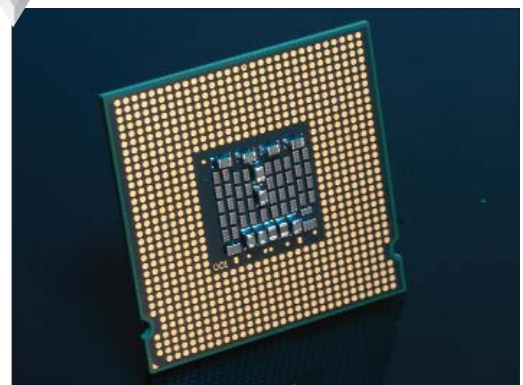
If you are into serious gaming but are on a limited budget (around Rs 50,000-60,000 for the entire rig) then a processor priced between Rs 10,000 and Rs 16,000 is what you should be looking for.



The Intel Core 2 Extreme QX 6700—the Quad beats the competition hollow



The Intel Core 2 Duo E6400 priced at a palatable Rs 11,600 is a real gem. With an impressive performance, it is one of the better processors available for a gaming machine—great value for money. If you can shell out the extra Rs 5500, then the Core 2 Duo E6600 is what we recommend for a true gaming machine.



The Intel Core 2 Extreme EX 6800 is the best for gamers

The High-end Gaming Machine

No point blowing money on an extremely high-end processor! The Core 2 Duo E6700 offers a performance that is just 10 per cent less than the top-end Core 2 Duo Extreme EX6800 and Core 2 Extreme QX6700—at half the price! The rest of your money is better spent getting on 2 GB of memory or an NVIDIA 7900GTX. If you have enough money stashed away, however, go for the Quad Core QX6700. It has enough fire power for now, and is the most future-proof of the lot. ☐

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